

HERCULES

Super-strong demigod son of Zeus



During his 12 labors, Hercules killed a flock of man-eating birds belonging to his half-brother Ares, the god of war, who has hated him ever since.

PRINCE OF POWER

Hercules is known throughout Olympus as the Prince of Power and he lives for the thrill of battle.

He also believes that it is a great honor to fight him and often bestows this so-called "gift" on both friends and foes alike. Instead of a handshake, Hercules likes to greet his fellow Avengers with a friendly punch in the face!

In modern times, Hercules met and battled Thor when the thunder god accidentally journeyed to Olympus. Hercules later traveled to Earth to renew his acquaintance with the Asgardian and unwittingly signed a contract that made him Pluto's slave. After being rescued by Thor, Hercules returned to Olympus until the ENCHANTRESS cast a spell on him and sent him to battle the Avengers. He later joined the team when Zeus temporarily exiled him to Earth. He was taken prisoner by Ares and his minions, but rescued by the Avengers. Hercules joined Thor on a journey to the far end of the galaxy, where they battled the Destroyer, FIRELORD and EGO, THE LIVING PLANET. He also joined the Los Angeles super-team known as the Champions and spent time as one of the DEFENDERS.



Hercules has been unlucky in love. He falls for mortal women who grow old and die while he remains young.

THE TRIALS OF HERCULES

After the Avengers were disassembled, Hercules starred in a reality TV show. He stood against the Superhuman Registration Act and has been a fugitive from the US government ever since. In the climactic battle of the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), he killed the clone of THOR with the creature's own false hammer. He allied with the HULK during World War Hulk (see pp. 152-5), after which the Hulk's friend Amadeus Cho joined him in his travels. During the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7), Hercules led the God Squad into battle with the SKRULL gods and defeated them. Recently, Hercules rejoined a new version of the Avengers. **TD, MF**

Though outnumbered, Hercules tried to defeat the Masters of Evil and almost paid the price.



Hercules is the son of Zeus, king of the Gods of Olympus, and a mortal woman. He is best known for his Twelve Labors, which he carried out to prove that he was worthy of immortality. He also made three enemies during the course of these labors: Ares, the god of war, Pluto (Hades), the lord of the underworld and Typhon, the giant son of Titan.



Hercules often greets Thor with the "gift" of his power—in the form of a punch in the face!

Virtually immortal. Trained in hand-to-hand combat and ancient Greek wrestling skills. Excellent archer. Wields a practically indestructible golden mace.

Hercules can be rash and stubborn but is usually gregarious and exuberant. He is a faithful friend and valiant warrior who loves the thrill of battle.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Hercules; aliases Heracles, Harry Cleese

OCCUPATION

Adventurer

BASE

Olympus

HEIGHT 6 ft 5 in

WEIGHT 325 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Dark brown

FIRST APPEARANCE:

Journey Into Mystery Annual #1 (1965)

HERCULES

POWERS

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Thor #124-130** Hercules' first journey to Earth in modern times: enslaved by Pluto, rescued by Thor.
- **The Avengers: Under Siege tpb** Zemo's new Masters of Evil invade Avengers Mansion and almost beat Hercules to death.
- **Hercules: Prince of Power tpb** Hercules confronts Galactus in the far future.